

Tunes over the air!

It all started back in 2004, when Apple released AirTunes, a not quite groundbreaking feature that let you stream music to remote speakers from a running instance of iTunes from a Mac. This was also the time when they were trying to replace Wi-Fi as we know it, with AirPort (thank god that never took off). AirTunes basically was a protocol to stream music coded in Apple's proprietary codec via Airport Express or even vanilla 802.11b/g networks. All the heavy lifting of decoding music from the regular formats such as MP3 and recoding it before broadcast was handled by iTunes. There were other several (admittedly rudimentary) music streaming devices and protocols so AirTunes never really took off. At least, not until 2010. AirTunes got a major overhaul and was rebadged as AirPlay and the functionality was added to iPhones and iPads as well. It's popularity grew, when a year later, screen mirroring was baked into AirPlay. Being able to go from watching something on your small screen mobile device (not so small in the case of an iPad) to seamless switching over to a large screen TV was a feature users soon grew very accustomed to. Some even began wondering how they had even lived without it for so long.

And keeping with the spirit of everything Apple, it's pretty easy to use as well. All you need is an iOS device that is running something that's later than iOS 4.2 or a computer running iTunes plus OS X Mountain Lion or later. You also need a second generation or newer Apple TV or an AirPlay enabled speakers. Just connect the sending device and the receiving device to the same WiFi network, swipe up to open up the Control Center and



When that beach is so good, you need to have it on every screen